HOMEMADE PUMPKIN CINNAMON ROLLS

FALL

Pumpkin spice filling • Cream cheese frosting • 8 large or 12 smaller rolls

Recipe by **Kiley Heard** · Well Made by Kiley
https://www.wellmadebykiley.com/blog/homemade-pumpkin-cinnamon-rolls

OVEN	PAN	PREP	TOTAL
350°F, then 375°F	**9×13", buttered**	**30 mins**	**2 hrs 45 mins**

> ***Don't over-rise:*** The first rise is only 30–45 minutes, and the dough won't double. That's on purpose: a longer rise makes the rolls too airy.

Ingredients

DOUGH

- **¾ cup (180ml)** milk of choice, warmed to 110°F (warm bath, not hot)
- **½ cup (120g)** brown sugar, light or dark, divided
- **2½ tsp (11g)** active dry yeast (or instant yeast)
- **½ cup (120g)** pumpkin purée (not pie filling), room temp
- **½ cup (113g)** salted butter, very softened (almost melted)
- **1 egg**, room temp
- **1 tsp (4g)** vanilla bean paste or extract
- **4½ cups (540g)** bread flour (or all-purpose), spooned and leveled
- **1 tsp (6g)** salt
- **2 tsp (4g)** pumpkin pie spice
- **1½ tsp (3g)** cinnamon

PUMPKIN SPICE FILLING

- **½ cup (113g)** salted butter, softened (not melted)
- **1¼ cups (300g)** light brown sugar
- **¼ cup (60g)** pumpkin purée
- **1 tbsp (6g)** cinnamon
- **2 tsp (4g)** pumpkin pie spice
- **1 tsp (4g)** vanilla bean paste or extract

BEFORE BAKING

Instructions

DOUGH

1. Stir 1 tbsp of the brown sugar into the warm milk and sprinkle the yeast over the top. Let it sit 5–7 minutes, until frothy. (With instant yeast, skip the wait.)
2. In a large bowl, whisk together the flour, salt, pumpkin pie spice, and cinnamon.
3. In a stand mixer bowl, combine the yeast mixture, the rest of the brown sugar, the pumpkin, butter, egg, vanilla, and flour mixture. Mix with the dough hook on low for 1 minute, until barely combined, then rest 5 minutes.
4. Mix on medium 5–7 minutes (or knead by hand 7–9 minutes) until smooth, elastic, and pulling away from the bowl. If it's very sticky, add flour 1 tbsp at a time, but keep it slightly tacky.
5. Cover in a lightly greased bowl and let rise somewhere warm for **30–45 minutes only**.

FILL & SHAPE

6. While the dough rises, mix all the filling ingredients until combined. A little curdling is fine; it melts in the oven.
7. Butter a 9×13" pan. On a lightly floured surface, roll the dough to **16×15"** for 8 large rolls or **24×15"** for 12 smaller rolls.
8. Spread the filling evenly over the dough, leaving a very thin border.
9. Cut along the long side into 2"-wide strips. Roll each strip up from the short end into a tight coil and tuck the tail underneath. (Or roll the whole sheet into a log and slice 2" rolls with a sharp knife or unflavored floss.)
10. Arrange in the pan, cover, and proof 25–30 minutes until puffy while the oven heats to 350°F.

BAKE & FROST

- **½ cup (120ml)** heavy cream, for pouring over the rolls

CREAM CHEESE FROSTING

- **8 oz (250g; 1 block)** cream cheese, softened
- **¼ cup (58g)** salted butter, softened
- **1¾ cups (210g)** powdered sugar
- **1 tsp (4g)** vanilla bean paste or extract

11. Warm the cream about 15 seconds in the microwave and pour it all over the rolls.
12. Bake at 350°F (22–24 minutes for 8 large rolls, 20–22 minutes for 12 smaller), then raise the oven to 375°F and bake 5–7 minutes more, until golden and cooked through.
13. While they bake, beat the cream cheese and butter until fluffy, then beat in the powdered sugar and vanilla.
14. Rest the rolls 10–15 minutes, spread on the frosting while they're still warm, and serve.

OVERNIGHT

Assemble the rolls in the pan, cover tightly, and refrigerate overnight instead of the second proof. In the morning, let them come to room temperature and proof 45–60 minutes, then add the cream and bake.

STORAGE

Covered at room temperature for 1 day (keep frosting in the fridge separately), frosted in the fridge for 3 days, or unfrosted and frozen for up to 2 months. Reheat at 325°F for 10–15 minutes and frost fresh.